



MASTERMIND
INDIA

Spirit of India Special



SMALL WONDER

| By Farzand Ahmed |

Steve Jobs, co-founder Apple Inc, once said: "Innovation distinguishes between a leader and a follower." The Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur (IIT-K), assumed the position of a leader in the field of space research when it handed over the country's first nano satellite, Jugnu, which means a firefly, to President Pratibha Patil, who in

turn handed it over to the Indian Space Research Organisation, ISRO, to test launch it from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre at Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh. The team being led by Nalinaksh S. Vyas, head of mechanical engineering, hopes to develop indigenous miniaturised technologies for future space missions during IIT-K's Golden Jubilee year.

Vyas, who is spearheading a research team of 45 students, including

five women and 14 professors, says: "Our aim is to provide real-life design and development experience of actual space systems to students".

The students on the project are led by Shantanu Agrawal, 22, who holds a dual B. Tech and M. Tech degree. He was earlier also actively involved in the technology mission on railway safety. An ecstatic Agrawal, who comes from a Meerut-based business family, says Jugnu has everything that